DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

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1st year

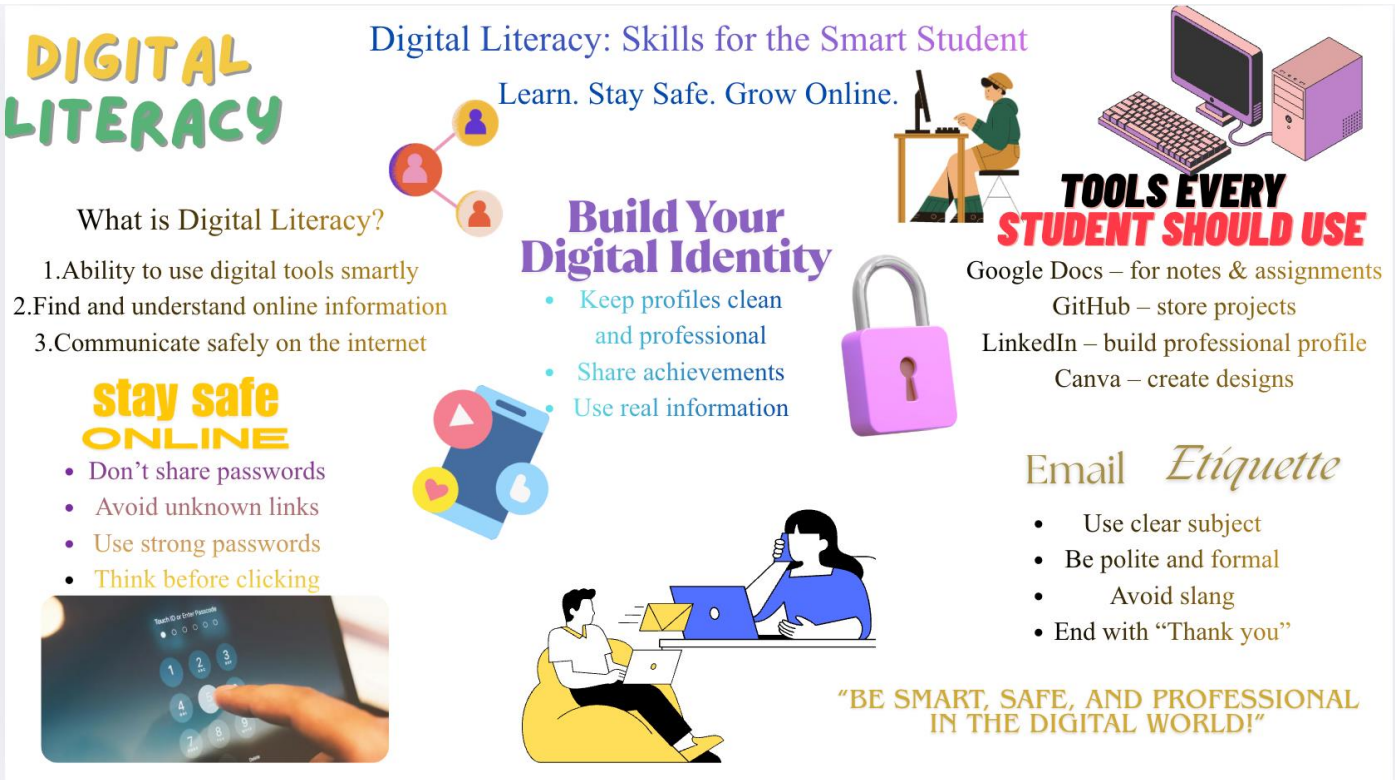
Overview of the Project:

This initiative aims to enhance digital literacy and professional online capabilities by completing five tasks. Each module covered practical elements like designing infographics, building a digital portfolio, investigating coding and collaboration tools, writing professional emails with proper etiquette, and examining awareness about cybercrime. Collectively, these tasks contributed to enhancing technical skills, interpersonal communication, and responsible behavior when using the internet.

Scenario:

In the scenario, I was assigned the role of a Digital Ambassador, tasked with helping my peers use digital tools in a safe, effective, and professional manner. The project highlighted both the opportunities and risks in the digital world, ranging from learning how to present ourselves online to understanding threats such as phishing and cyberbullying. The main goal was to equip students to become intelligent, cautious, and accountable digital citizens, prepared to face academic and career-related challenges.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic:



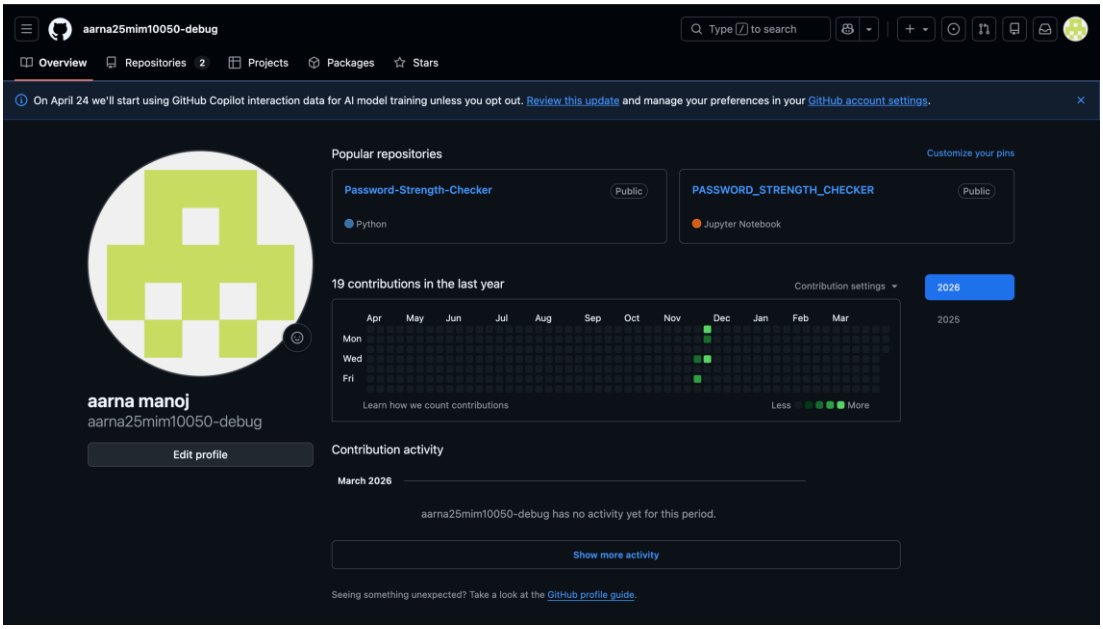
I used Canva to design my digital literacy infographic because it is easy to use and it also provides many templates, icons, and design elements. My poster explains the concept of digital literacy and why it is important for students nowadays. It includes sections on what digital literacy means, useful digital tools like GitHub and LinkedIn, safe internet practices students shouls follow, professional online presence, and email etiquette. Each section is presented with short points and simple visuals so that it is easy to understand at a glance.

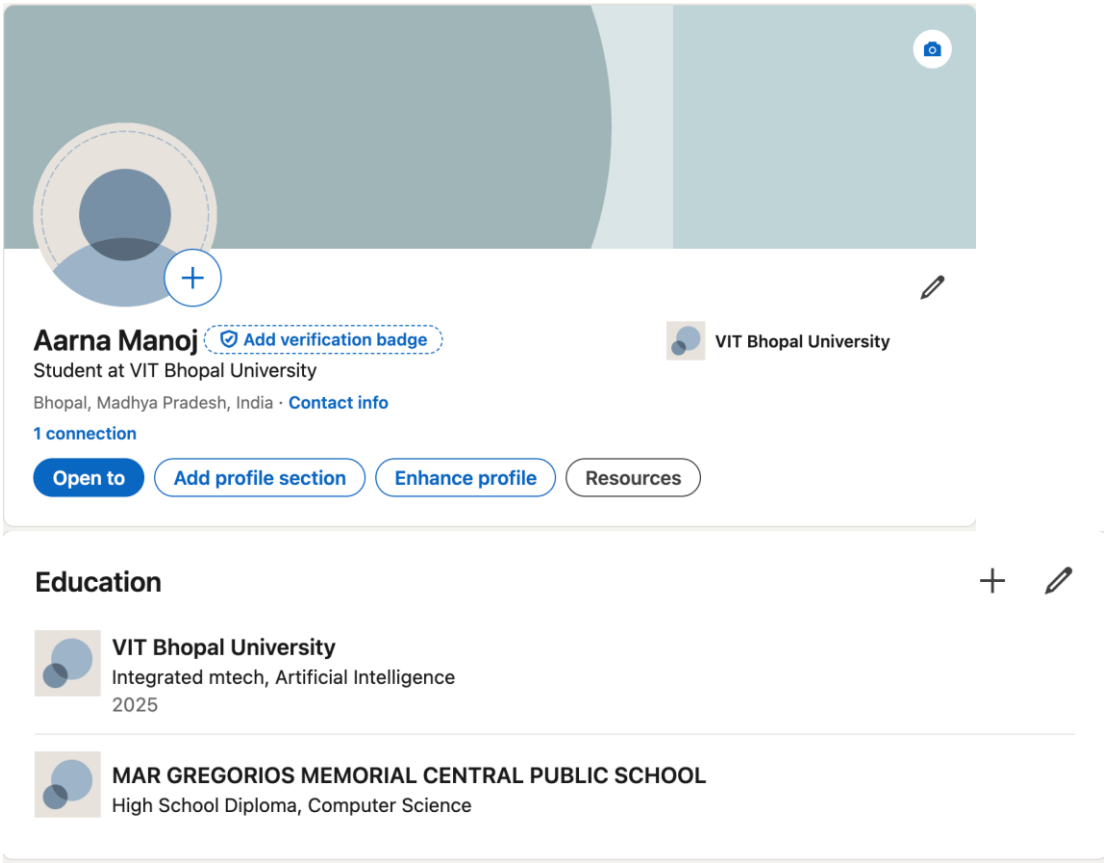
The design focuses on clarity and visual appeal by using icons, images, colors, and minimal text instead of long paragraphs. This makes the information more engaging and quick to read for students. One thing I found difficult was deciding how to organize all the information in a single page without making it look crowded. However, it was also interesting to experiment with different layouts, and colors to make the poster more attractive and attention seeking. Overall, this activity helped me understand how to present information clearly using digital tools.

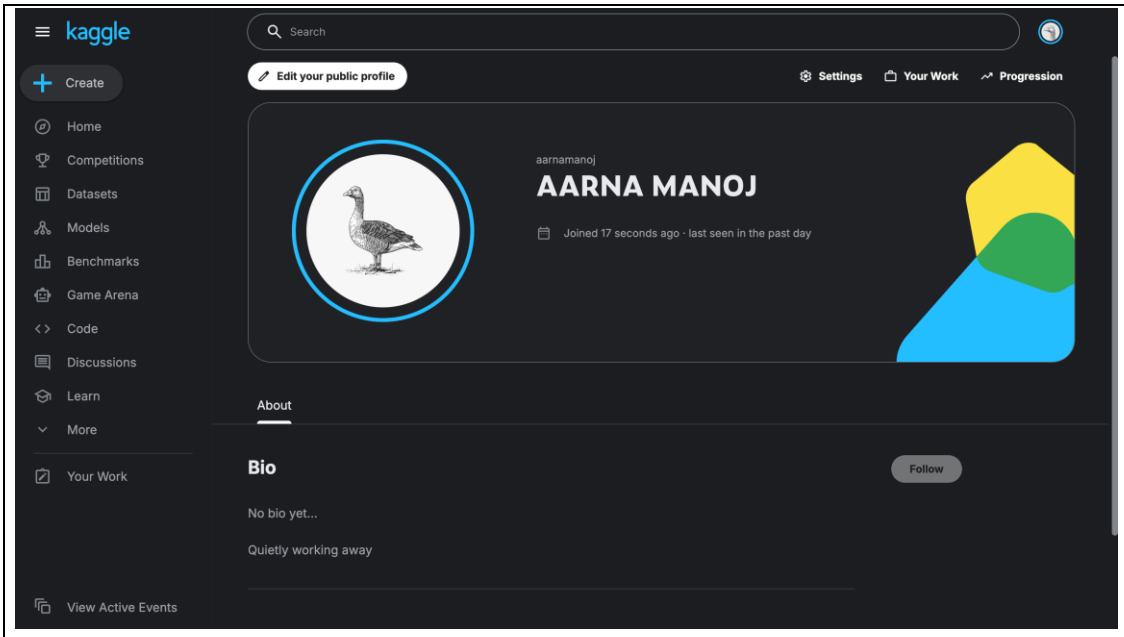
Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I created my digital portfolio using GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. On GitHub, I set up a profile README that features my name, current branch, academic year, and a brief statement outlining my learning objectives. This platform will act as a display for my coding projects and teamwork. On LinkedIn, I revised my Education section to include my current degree, the university I'm studying at, and the year I anticipate graduating. LinkedIn will assist me in connecting with colleagues, professors, and possible employers while showcasing my academic and career accomplishments. On Kaggle, I created a profile to examine datasets and take part in competitions, which will enhance my abilities in data analysis and machine learning.

It was intriguing to observe how each platform emphasizes various aspects of career development. Combined, they form a solid base for my digital identity, which I intend to develop further over the next four years through projects, research, and building professional connections.



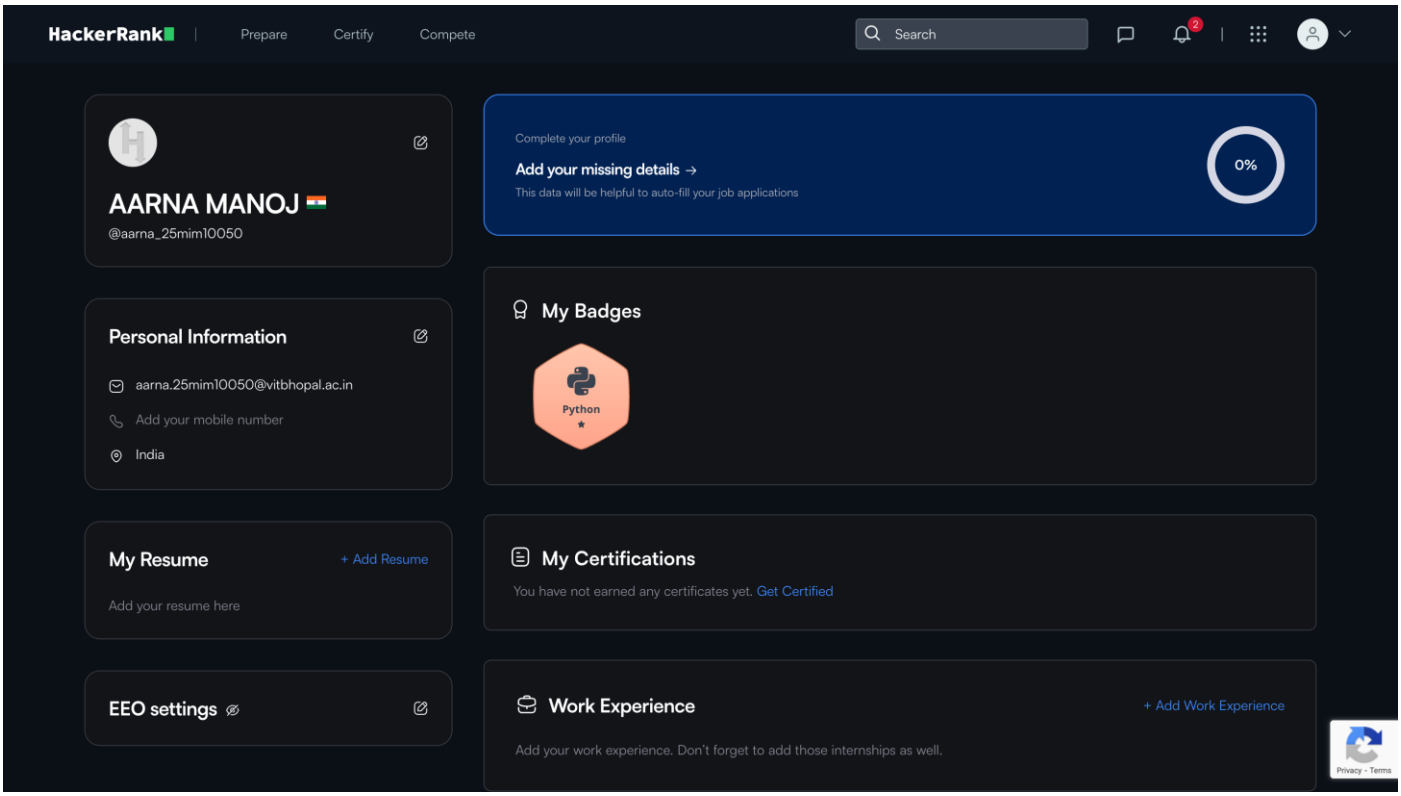




Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

PART-1

HackerRank:



PART-2

Quiz on Digital Literacy - Google Forms
https://docs.google.com/forms/d/1Aa67cwBou9-mYWtAJZ5AQQT2h60r-OCjBD0mAoIMxzc/edit

Digital Literacy Quiz

Form description

What does Digital Literacy mean? *

- Ability to use digital devices and tools effectively
- Only using social media
- Playing online games
- Watching videos online

Which of the following is a safe internet practice? *

- Sharing your password with friends
- Clicking unknown links
- Using strong and unique passwords
- Downloading files from unknown sources

Using strong and unique passwords
Downloading files from unknown sources

Which platform is mainly used for professional networking? *

- Instagram
- WhatsApp
- LinkedIn
- Snapchat

What should you include in a professional email? *

- Slang language
- Clear subject and polite tone
- Emojis only
- No greeting

Form_Responses

Timestamp	Score	What does Digital Literacy mean?	Which of the following is a safe internet prac	Which platform is mainly used for profession	What should you include in a profession
3/31/2026 20:41:16	0 / 1	Ability to use digital devices and tools	Clicking unknown links	WhatsApp	Emojis only

For this task, I collaborated with HackerRank and Google Workspace. On HackerRank, I set up an account and tackled the beginner-level problem called “Solve Me First.” This activity familiarized me with the programming environment and allowed me to work on problem-solving while receiving immediate feedback. I found the points system and achievements encouraging, as they promote steady learning and progress in programming abilities.

For the collaboration section, I created a Google Form containing five questions for a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz, using both multiple choice and short answer formats. I connected the form to a Google Sheet, enabling me to see responses as they were submitted. This showed how Google Workspace tools can make surveys, gathering feedback, and team projects easier.

These platforms will generally support my academic progress by improving my coding skills and facilitating better collaboration with classmates, thereby making teamwork and learning more effective.

Task 4: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Part A: Two professional emails

prof@vitbhopal.ac.in

Request for Extension on Assignment Submission

Dear Professor,

I hope you are doing well. I am writing to request an extension for the submission of my assignment for your course.

Due to unforeseen circumstances, I have been unable to complete the assignment within the given deadline. I want to ensure that I submit quality work that reflects my understanding of the subject, and an extension would greatly help me achieve that.

I kindly request you to grant me an extension of a few days. I assure you that I will make the best use of this additional time and submit the assignment at the earliest possible date.

Thank you for your time and understanding. I look forward to your consideration.

Yours sincerely,
Aarna Manoj
25MIM10050

prof@vitbhopal.ac.in

Application for Summer Internship Opportunity

Dear Madam,

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to express my interest in a summer internship opportunity at your organization.

I am currently a first-year B.Tech student at VIT Bhopal University, pursuing my degree in Computer Science. I am eager to gain practical experience and enhance my technical and professional skills. I am particularly interested in learning more about real-world applications and contributing to ongoing projects within your organization.

I am a motivated and quick learner, and I am confident that this internship would provide me with valuable exposure to the industry. I would be grateful for the opportunity to be considered for any suitable internship roles available during the upcoming summer.

Please find my details attached for your reference. I would be happy to provide any additional information if required.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to your response.

Yours sincerely,
Aarna Manoj
25MIM10050

Part B: Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist

Do's

- Use professional language when posting or commenting.
- Share academic achievements, projects, or internships to build your profile.
- Respect others' opinions and engage politely in discussions.
- Keep privacy settings updated to control who sees your content.
- Verify information before sharing to avoid spreading misinformation.

Don'ts

- Don't post offensive or discriminatory remarks.
- Don't overshare personal details like phone numbers or addresses.
- Don't upload inappropriate photos or content that could harm your reputation.
- Don't engage in online arguments or trolling.
- Don't plagiarize or copy others' work without credit.

Ineffective digital communication can quickly lead to confusion and harm professional relationships. As an example, I once came across a story about a student who sent an email to a professor using informal language, omitted a subject line, and provided insufficient information when asking for more time. The professor considered the email to be confusing and unprofessional, resulting in the request being turned down. This scenario shows how not adhering to email etiquettelike using an appropriate greeting, a clear subject line, and a respectful tonecan lead to unfavorable results.

What could have been done differently was straightforward: the student should have composed a well-organized email with a clear topic line, politely stated the need for an extension, and concluded with a professional sign-off. By following appropriate manners, the message would have been considered more seriously, significantly increasing the student's likelihood of getting a favorable reply.

TASK-5 Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Part A:Case Study

Case Study: PHISHING
Phishing is a depictive cybercrime where attackers pose a legitimate entities suct as banks, government agencies or popular online services to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information like usernames ,passwords and financial details.
How It Happens (Step-by-Step)

1. Lure initiation: The attackers sends a fraudulent email or SMS that appears to be from a trusted source such as security alert from major bank.
2. Social Engineering: The message creates a sense of urgency, claiming the victims account will be suspended unless they "verify" their details immediately.
3. The Hook: The victim clicks a provide link, which redirects them to a spoofed website that looks identical to the official one .
4. Data Harvesting: The victim enters their login credentials or credit card numbers on the fake website, which attacker captures in real time.
5. Exploitation: The attacker uses the stolen the data to drain bank accounts ,make unauthorized purchases, or sell the information on the dark web.

Target Audience
While anyone with an internet connection is a potential target, attackers often
focus on elderly individuals less familiar with tech security and employees of large organizations to gain corporate network access.
Consequences
ictims face sever e financial loss, damage credit scores, and long term stress of identity theft .For business,a single successful phishing link can lead to massive data breaches and irreparable reputational damage.

Part B: Prevention Checklist

Prevention Checklist:
-Stay safe Online check list for indian students:

- Enable 2-Factor Authentication(2FA) Everywhere.
- Use Strong and Unique Passwords.
- Beware of "Too-Good-To-Be-True" offers.
- Verify before you click (Phishing Protection).
- Secure your phone screen lock.
- Avoid public Wi-Fi for sensetive tasks.
- UPI Safety: Never Enter PIN TO receive money remember, you never need to enter your PIN to receive money
- UPI Safety: Check beneficiary name before paying.

EMERGENCY: THNGS WHAT TO DO IF SCAMMED
act within the first hour ("Golden Hour") to increase the reversing the transaction •

- Helpline: Call 1930 (National Cyber Crime Helpline)24X7 to report finincial fraud and freeze the money.
- Portal: Register a formal complaint on cybercrime.gov.in.
- Evidence: Take screenshots of the payment , message, phonenumber or UPI id of scammer

While looking into phishing, I was most surprised by how realistic fake emails and websites can appear. Attackers frequently imitate logos and language so effectively that even careful students might be deceived by them. I came to understand that paying attention to minor details, such as verifying the sender's address or the correct spelling of a URL, can greatly help in identifying fraudulent activity. Personally, one habit I plan to alter is opening links directly from emails. Instead, I will always manually enter the official website address or use bookmarked links. This straightforward action lowers the chance of being sent to a counterfeit website. The study showed me that preventing cybercrime relies more on regularly practicing safe habits than on using sophisticated tools.

Conclusion

This project helped me develop a better understanding of digital literacy, professional communication, collaboration tools, and awareness of cybercrime. Every task, whether it involved creating infographics, developing a digital portfolio, experimenting with coding platforms, writing professional emails, or investigating cybercrime, helped me bridge theoretical knowledge with real-world skills. I discovered the significance of keeping a professional online image, adopting safe internet practices, and using digital tools in a responsible manner. The case study focusing on phishing particularly emphasized the dangers of inattentive online activities and the importance of being cautious. This project has enhanced both my technical abilities and communication skills, while also influencing my digital identity as a student. Going forward, I will put these lessons into practice in my academic projects, internships, and professional connections, making sure I stay intelligent, secure, and accountable online.

References

- *Google Chrome*
- *HackerRank*
- *Chatgpt*
- *Canva*
- *Git hub*
- *Kaggle*

THANK YOU